www.tntextbooks.in

marrow (Pneumatic bones). This reduces the weight of the body. The **breast bone** or **sternum** has a broad plate of bone produced ventrally into a prominent vertical **crest** or **keel** to which the powerful muscles of flight are attached.

Flight muscles

Wings are modified forelimbs and the organs of flight. The musculature of the forelimbs are greatly modified in response to the function they perform. Flight is the coordinated effort of a number of paired muscles. The muscles which operate the wings during flight are called **flight muscles**. The major flight muscles of pigeon are the **pectoral muscles**. Pectoral muscles are of two types namely the **Pectoralis major** and **Pectoralis minor**. The pectoralis major muscle is a large and

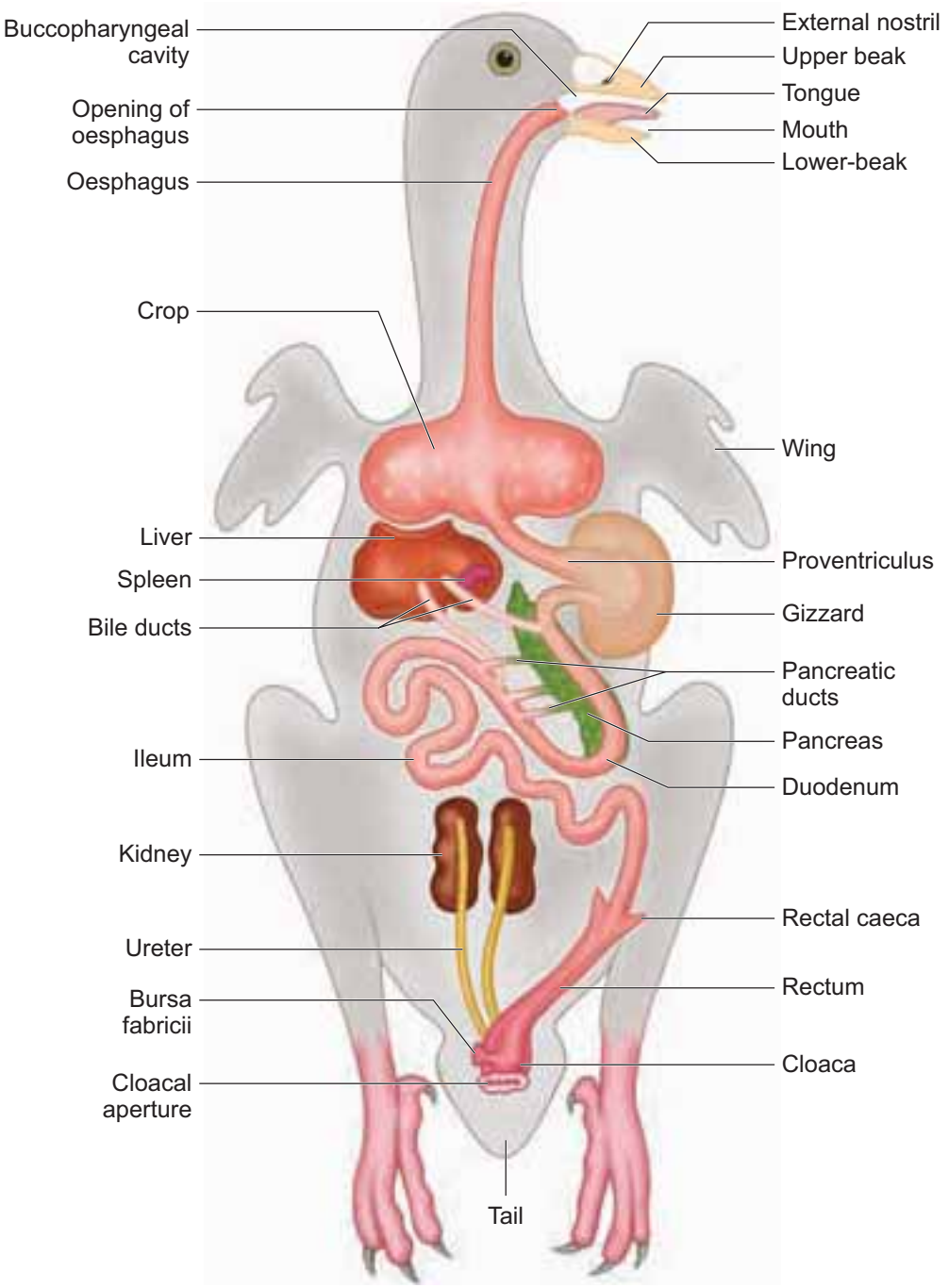

Figure 4.29 Pigeon – Digestive System